English • Romantic poetry, nature and memory

Daffodils

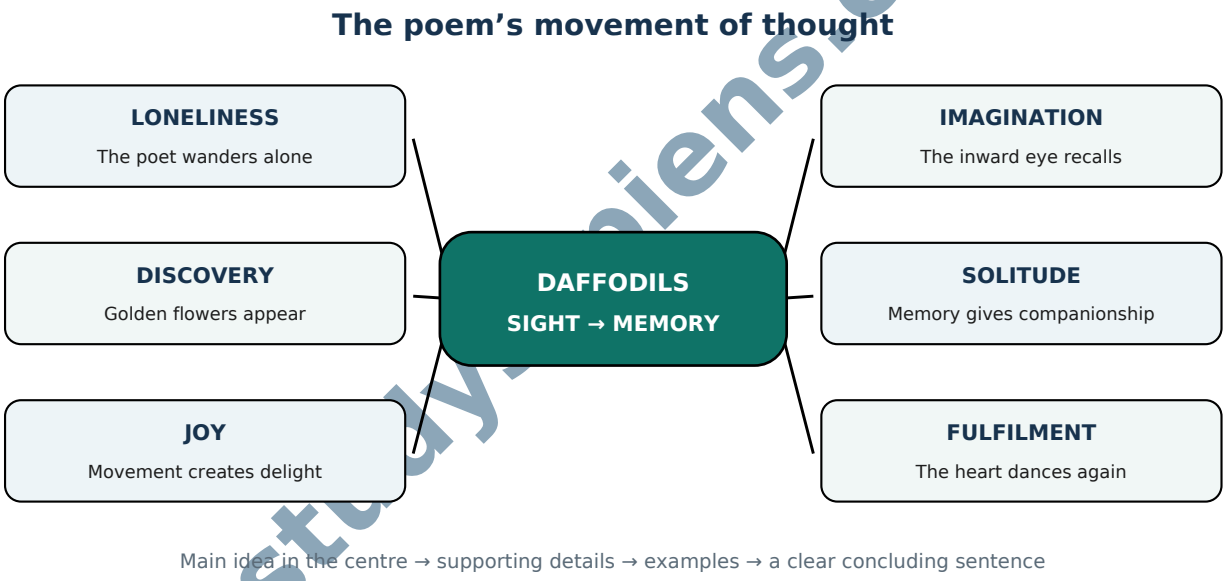
William Wordsworth • Official activities • Paraphrases • Poetic devices • Summary

Unit 3 • Poem • Complete official activities • Paraphrase + Figurative Language + Summary

Poem at a glance

• **Poet:** William Wordsworth (1770–1850), a major English Romantic poet who celebrated nature's power to inspire and heal.
• **Central idea:** A joyful encounter with daffodils becomes a lasting memory that later comforts and delights the poet in solitude.
• **Form:** Four six-line stanzas, generally iambic tetrameter, with **ABABCC** rhyme in each stanza.
• **Key devices:** Simile, personification, hyperbole, metaphor, imagery, alliteration and assonance.

Figure 1 — Original emotional and imaginative journey in "Daffodils"



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Coverage note: All official reading, vocabulary, grammar, oral and writing tasks are answered. Four stanza paraphrases are supplied for revision; the required final-stanza paraphrase and objective summary appear again in their official sections.

Pre-Reading and While-Reading

P1. Imagine yourself in the daffodil landscape. How might it make you feel?

The open hills, quiet lake and moving golden flowers could make me feel calm and refreshed. The bright colour and gentle movement would create cheerfulness, while the natural silence would encourage reflection. A personal response may vary, but it should connect feeling with details in the setting.

P2. Have you ever witnessed daffodils or another flower? How did you feel?

Model response: I once saw mustard flowers spreading across a field. Their yellow colour seemed to brighten the whole landscape, and their movement in the wind made the field appear alive. I felt peaceful and wanted to remember the scene, just as the poet remembers the daffodils.

P3. How might the natural world be described in the poem?

A reasonable prediction is that nature will be beautiful, lively and emotionally restorative. The flowers may be personified as dancers, and the landscape may appeal to sight and sound. After reading, these predictions are confirmed, while the added importance of memory may be a pleasant surprise.

Margin questions. Quick comprehension in poem order.

Question	Answer
Who is the speaker, and what is he doing at the beginning?	The poet/speaker is wandering alone, comparing himself to a cloud above valleys and hills.
Which natural element is he compared to?	A cloud drifting high over the landscape.
Where does he find the daffodils, and how are they described?	Beside a lake and beneath trees; they are a golden host fluttering and dancing in the breeze.
How is their number described?	They seem continuous as stars, stretch in a never-ending line and are estimated at ten thousand at a glance.
What action do they perform in the breeze?	They toss their heads in a sprightly dance.
How do the waves compare with the daffodils?	The waves also dance, but the daffodils surpass them in glee.
What effect do they have on the poet’s mood?	Their jocund company makes him gay; later, their memory fills him with pleasure.
What is “jocund company”?	The cheerful, lively presence of the daffodils, imagined as companions.
What happens when he lies on his couch in a vacant or pensive mood?	The remembered flowers flash upon his inward eye.
What is the inward eye?	The faculty of memory and imagination that allows him to see the scene inwardly.

Question	Answer
How does the memory affect him at the end?	His heart fills with pleasure and dances with the daffodils.

Stanza-by-Stanza Paraphrase Support

Stanza 1 — Encounter

• The speaker wanders alone like a cloud floating above valleys and hills. Suddenly, he sees a large number of golden daffodils growing beside a lake and beneath trees. Their light movement in the breeze makes them appear to flutter and dance.

Stanza 2 — Abundance and movement

• The flowers appear as countless and continuous as stars shining and twinkling across the Milky Way. They form what seems to be an endless line along the edge of the bay. At a single glance, the speaker estimates that he sees ten thousand, all tossing their heads in an energetic dance.

Stanza 3 — Immediate joy

• The waves beside the flowers dance too, but the daffodils seem even more joyful than the sparkling water. In such cheerful company, the poet cannot help feeling happy. He continues to gaze, without yet realizing how valuable and lasting the memory of this sight will become.

Stanza 4 — Lasting emotional wealth

• Later, whenever the poet lies on his couch feeling empty or deeply thoughtful, the image of the daffodils returns vividly to his memory and imagination. This recollection is the happiness he can enjoy in solitude. His heart then fills with pleasure and joins the flowers in their joyful dance.

Reading and Critical Thinking

A. Answer the following questions.

1. What is the central idea of “Daffodils”?

The poem shows that beauty in nature can create joy that continues through memory. The daffodils first transform the poet’s loneliness into delight and later return through his inward eye, allowing him to experience companionship and pleasure in solitude.

2. Describe the setting and its contribution to the poem's mood.

The daffodils grow beside a lake, beneath trees and along the margin of a bay, with valleys, hills, a breeze and sparkling waves completing the scene. This open, peaceful landscape makes the golden movement especially vivid. The setting changes the mood from cloud-like loneliness to brightness, energy and harmony.

3. How does the poet describe the daffodils and bring them to life?

He calls them a crowd and a host of golden flowers, compares their continuity to stars, and estimates ten thousand at a glance. Verbs such as fluttering, dancing and tossing personify their movement. Visual imagery of gold, stars, the lake and the Milky Way creates scale and brilliance, while dance imagery supplies energy and joy.

4. Identify and explain personification in the poem.

The daffodils "dance", "toss their heads" and form "jocund company"; the waves "dance" too. At the end, the poet's heart "dances with the daffodils". These human actions and emotions make nature seem alive and companionable. They also communicate the infectious movement of the scene and the poet's emotional participation in it.

5. What is the effect of the rhyme scheme on rhythm and flow?

Each stanza follows **ABABCC**. The alternating rhymes carry the reader smoothly through the first four lines, while the final couplet gives a neat, musical conclusion. Together with generally iambic tetrameter, this regularity produces a light, memorable rhythm suited to the flowers' dancing movement.

6. Why are the daffodils called "jocund company", and what impact do they have?

Their number, brightness and dancing movement make them feel like a cheerful gathering rather than static plants. They free the poet from loneliness and make him gay. Later, the same remembered company turns solitary reflection into pleasure, proving that their influence lasts beyond the physical encounter.

7. What is the "bliss of solitude", and how do the daffodils contribute?

It is the deep happiness of being alone while the mind is enriched by beautiful memories and imagination. Solitude is no longer painful loneliness because the inward eye recalls the daffodils. Their remembered image gives the poet companionship, peace and renewed joy without requiring another person to be present.

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8. Imagine revisiting the place after many years. Describe your feelings and the scene.

Model paragraph: Years later, I return to the same quiet bay with a slower step but a quicker heartbeat. The lake still shines beneath the trees, and a fresh host of daffodils bends and rises in the breeze. Their gold seems familiar, as if the years have folded into a single bright moment. I remember my earlier loneliness and realize that this landscape has accompanied me through many difficult days. Feeling grateful rather than sorrowful, I stand silently and let the dancing flowers renew the joy they first gave me.

B. Choose the correct option.

1. What is the primary theme?

(b) the beauty of nature. The poem also develops memory, solitude and emotional uplift through that beauty.

2. To what does the poet compare himself at the beginning?

(c) a cloud. The simile suggests drifting loneliness and detachment.

3. Where does he see the daffodils?

(c) beside a lake. They also grow beneath trees along a bay.

4. How is their movement described?

(c) fluttering and dancing.

5. To what are they compared in their continuous stretch?

(b) a starry night. More precisely, they are continuous as stars shining and twinkling on the Milky Way.

6. How many does he estimate at a glance?

(b) thousands. The exact poetic estimate is “ten thousand”; “tens of thousands” would suggest a larger range.

7. How does he feel before seeing them?

(b) lonely.

8. What effect does their later memory have?

(c) they bring him joy.

9. Which phrase describes his reflective moments?

(b) in a vacant or in pensive mood.

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10. Which line best conveys their lasting impact?

(c) “And then my heart with pleasure fills.” The emotion returns when the scene is remembered.

Vocabulary: Denotation, Connotation and Nuance

A. Synonyms with similar denotations but different connotations.

Pair	Shared denotation	Different connotations and model sentences
lonely / solitary	being alone	Lonely often suggests painful isolation: “She felt lonely in the new city.” Solitary can suggest chosen peace: “He enjoyed a solitary walk.”
gazed / stared	looked for a long time	Gazed suggests wonder or admiration: “I gazed at the golden flowers.” Stared can seem rude or fixed: “He stared until she felt uncomfortable.”
jocund / happy	cheerful	Jocund is poetic and suggests lively merriment: “The jocund dancers filled the hall.” Happy is neutral and everyday: “I am happy today.”

Nuance and tone: Word choice changes emotional colour even when dictionary meanings overlap. “Lonely” emphasizes painful absence; “solitude” in the poem’s final stanza becomes beneficial because memory supplies companionship. In a different context, a “solitary” person may seem either peaceful or isolated, depending on the surrounding details.

B. Denotative and connotative meanings of poem words.

Word	Denotation	Connotation in the poem
lonely	alone; without company	sadness, isolation and aimless drifting
cloud	a visible mass of water droplets in the sky	lightness, distance, wandering and loneliness
fluttering	moving lightly and quickly	delicacy, liveliness and playful motion

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Word	Denotation	Connotation in the poem
sprightly	full of life and energy	cheerful vitality and spirited dancing
gazed	looked steadily for a long time	wonder, absorption and admiration
bliss	perfect happiness	deep peaceful joy found through memory in solitude

C. Specify positive and negative connotations.

Pair	Positive / gentler use	Negative / harsher use
gaze / stare	“Gaze” often suggests admiration: gaze at a painting.	“Stare” may suggest rudeness or aggression: stare at a stranger.
shine / glare	“Shine” suggests pleasant radiance: stars shine softly.	“Glare” suggests harsh, uncomfortable light: headlights glare.
hoard / collect	“Collect” suggests purposeful, reasonable gathering: collect stamps.	“Hoard” suggests excessive or selfish accumulation: hoard essential supplies.

Grammar: Figurative Language

A. Answer the analysis questions.

1. Identify the simile in the first line and explain its contribution to mood.

“I wandered lonely as a cloud” compares the speaker’s movement to a cloud drifting above the landscape. The comparison suggests isolation, lack of direction and emotional distance. It establishes a subdued mood that later changes to joy.

2. Give two examples of personification and explain their effect.

The daffodils “toss their heads in sprightly dance”, and they form “jocund company”. The waves also dance, and the poet’s heart dances at the end. These human actions make the natural scene lively and friendly, allowing the reader to feel the delight that passes from the flowers to the poet.

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3. What is the purpose of the hyperbole?

“Ten thousand saw I at a glance” emphasizes the immense number and overwhelming visual impact of the flowers. It need not be treated as a precise count. The exaggeration helps the reader understand the poet’s astonishment and the scene’s abundance.

4. Explain “They flash upon that inward eye”.

“Inward eye” is a metaphor for memory and imagination, while “flash” suggests a sudden, vivid return of the image. The line shows that the daffodils remain mentally bright and accessible long after the poet has left the physical scene.

5. Identify alliteration and its musical effect.

In “Beside the lake, beneath the trees”, the repeated /b/ sound links nearby words. Other sound patterns can also be heard in the poem. This repetition creates rhythm and unity, making the line pleasing and memorable.

6. Describe the star imagery and its effect.

The daffodils are “continuous as the stars that shine / And twinkle on the Milky Way”. The comparison gives the flowers immense number, brightness and apparent endlessness. By moving from a lakeside view to the vast night sky, Wordsworth enlarges the reader’s sense of wonder.

B. Choose appropriate words and phrases.

Item	Answer and reason
1. The baby’s skin was as soft as ___.	(c) silk — a gentle, suitable simile.
2. The wind ___ through the trees, whispering secrets.	(b) danced — supplies a human action; “whispering” also personifies the wind.
3. I was so hungry, I could eat a ___.	(c) horse — deliberate hyperbole, not a literal intention.
4. The sky was painted with hues of pink and ___ at sunset.	(c) orange — creates familiar visual sunset imagery.
5. Time is a great ___.	(d) healer — a metaphor presenting time as something that heals.
6. The lazy ___ sat on a mat.	(c) cat — repeats the /æ/ sound in lazy, cat, sat and mat.
7. The cold, crisp, ___ snow crunched underfoot.	(b) clean — continues the initial /k/ consonant sound, although other wording could sound more natural.

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C. Euphemism, oxymoron and poetic choice.

1. Why did Wordsworth choose certain figures of speech rather than others?

Simile and imagery make the landscape immediately visible; personification gives it emotional companionship; hyperbole communicates abundance; and metaphor explains the inward life of memory. These choices directly support the poem's movement from loneliness to joy. Euphemism and oxymoron are less useful because the poem neither softens an unpleasant subject nor centres on contradiction.

2. How would euphemism or oxymoron change the tone or impact?

Euphemism could make the language indirect and less vivid, weakening the clear sensory encounter. An oxymoron such as "joyful sorrow" would introduce tension and complexity, shifting attention away from harmonious delight. A different poem could use these devices effectively, but here they would alter the direct, uplifting tone.

3. How can oxymoron add depth, and why is it absent here?

Oxymoron joins opposing ideas to reveal mixed emotions or paradox, as in "deafening silence". It makes readers pause and reconsider a situation. "Daffodils" does contain an emotional contrast between loneliness and joyful solitude, but Wordsworth develops that contrast through the whole poem rather than compressing it into contradictory word pairs.

4. Why does a poet choose to use or avoid euphemism?

A poet uses euphemism to soften painful, embarrassing or socially sensitive subjects and to create restraint or politeness. A poet avoids it when direct, concrete or sensory language is needed. Wordsworth's subject is natural beauty rather than an uncomfortable event, so euphemism would add little and could reduce immediacy.

Grammar: Compound Prepositions and Phrases

D–E. Underline compound prepositions, then create sentences.

Textbook sentence	Compound preposition
According to the schedule, the meeting starts at 10 a.m.	according to
The park is located in front of the library.	in front of
She attended the conference on behalf of her manager.	on behalf of
We were late for school due to the heavy rain.	due to

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Textbook sentence	Compound preposition
In addition to his academic work, he participates in sports.	in addition to
In spite of the rain, the match continued.	in spite of

Prompt	Original sentence
according to	According to the map, the lake lies beyond the hill.
in front of	A row of daffodils grew in front of the library.
on behalf of	She read the summary on behalf of her group.
due to	The picnic was postponed due to heavy rain.
in addition to	In addition to the poem, we studied the poet’s biography.
in spite of	In spite of the cold wind, the walkers continued towards the bay.

F. Identify prepositional phrases and their functions.

Sentence	Prepositional phrase	Function
The book on the shelf is mine.	on the shelf	adjective phrase describing “book”
She recited with grace.	with grace	adverb phrase describing how she recited
They travelled to the mountains.	to the mountains	adverb phrase describing direction of travel
The cat under the table is sleeping.	under the table	adjective phrase describing “cat”
He arrived after dinner.	after dinner	adverb phrase telling when he arrived
The painting on the wall is beautiful.	on the wall	adjective phrase describing “painting”

G. Create original sentences with the given phrases.

1. in the morning: We revise our notes in the morning.

2. under the bed: The missing dictionary was under the bed.

3. with a smile: She welcomed the visitors with a smile.

4. after the game: The players shook hands after the game.

5. on the roof: Two sparrows rested on the roof.

Place each phrase close to the word it modifies. This prevents confusion and keeps the sentence clear.

Oral Communication: “Arrival of the Monsoon” Extract

Model recitation guidance

• Begin with renewed energy in “Alive, alive”, then soften slightly for the rain’s coolness on lips and eyes. Use surprise and movement for the swinging electric wire. Pause after the hooves and drenched trees so listeners can visualize each image. Let the final line settle into a satisfying close as summer ends in a flurry of drops.

A(iii). What is the main idea of Taufiq Rafat’s stanza extract?

The extract celebrates the monsoon’s power to renew a hot, weary landscape. Rain awakens the surroundings, refreshes living beings and brings summer to a dramatic close. The mood is energetic, sensory and joyful rather than merely descriptive of weather.

A(iv). What supporting details and imagery does the group presentation identify?

• **Repetition:** “Alive, alive” makes renewal sound immediate and exuberant.

• **Tactile and visual imagery:** Cool rain on lips and eyes lets the reader feel and see the relief.

• **Movement:** The electric wire swings “madly”, brown waters eddy around hooves, and trees shake themselves.

• **Personification:** The drenched trees rise and shake themselves like living beings refreshed by rain.

• **Colour and sound:** Brown water and a “flurry of drops” create a vivid, energetic closing scene.

Model conclusion: The stanza uses active verbs and sensory detail to show that monsoon rain restores movement, freshness and life to the whole environment.

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Paraphrasing and Summary Writing

A. Paraphrase the last stanza of “Daffodils”.

Required final-stanza paraphrase

• Often, when the poet lies on his couch feeling unoccupied or deeply thoughtful, the daffodils return vividly to his memory and imagination. This ability to recall beauty makes his solitude happy rather than lonely. The remembered scene fills his heart with pleasure, and he feels as if his heart is dancing joyfully with the flowers.

B. Write an objective summary of the poem.

Model objective summary

• In “Daffodils”, William Wordsworth recalls wandering alone until he suddenly sees a host of golden daffodils beside a lake and beneath trees. Their vast number suggests a never-ending line of stars, while their fluttering and dancing in the breeze makes them appear joyful and alive. The flowers delight him more than the dancing waves, though he does not immediately understand the lasting value of the sight. Later, in vacant or thoughtful moments, their image returns through memory and imagination. This recollection transforms solitude into bliss as his heart fills with pleasure and joins the daffodils’ dance. The poem therefore celebrates natural beauty, joyful memory and the restorative power of imagination.

Original Exam-Practice MCQs

1. Which best states the poem’s central idea?

(a) Nature is useful only for resources
(b) Beautiful memories of nature can restore joy
(c) Travel always removes sadness
(d) Solitude is always painful

Answer: (b) Beautiful memories of nature can restore joy — The sight becomes a lasting source of happiness.

2. The opening simile compares the speaker to:

(a) a star
(b) a wave
(c) a cloud
(d) a tree

Answer: (c) a cloud — He wanders lonely as a cloud.

3. The daffodils grow:

(a) beside a lake
(b) inside a house
(c) on a roof
(d) beside a road

Answer: (a) beside a lake — They are beside the lake and beneath trees.

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4. “Tossing their heads” is an example of:

(a) euphemism (b) personification
(c) preposition (d) denotation

Answer: (b) personification — The flowers receive a human action.

5. “Ten thousand” primarily functions as:

(a) a precise census (b) hyperbole emphasizing abundance
(c) a compound preposition (d) an oxymoron

Answer: (b) hyperbole emphasizing abundance — The poetic number emphasizes overwhelming abundance.

6. The inward eye represents:

(a) physical eyesight (b) memory and imagination
(c) the Milky Way (d) a camera

Answer: (b) memory and imagination — The scene returns vividly within the mind.

7. Each stanza’s rhyme scheme is:

(a) AAAAAA (b) ABABAB
(c) ABABCC (d) ABCABC

Answer: (c) ABABCC — Alternating rhyme ends with a rhyming couplet.

8. Which word usually has a negative connotation?

(a) gaze (b) collect
(c) hoard (d) shine

Answer: (c) hoard — Hoard suggests excessive or selfish accumulation.

9. “In front of the library” is:

(a) a conjunction (b) a compound-preposition phrase
(c) an infinitive (d) a rhyme

Answer: (b) a compound-preposition phrase — In front of works as one compound preposition.

10. An objective summary should contain:

(a) personal praise (b) every minor detail
(c) main ideas without personal opinion (d) a new ending

Answer: (c) main ideas without personal opinion — Summaries condense essential meaning objectively.

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Points to Remember

Structure: Lonely wandering → discovery → immediate delight → vivid recollection → joyful solitude.

Central idea: Nature's beauty can continue to heal and delight through memory.

ABABCC rhyme and regular rhythm create musical flow and a satisfying final couplet.

Denotation is literal meaning; **connotation** is emotional association; **nuance** is the subtle difference between near-synonyms.

Paraphrase keeps meaning and approximate scope in new words; **summary** condenses only essential ideas.

Compound preposition: in front of, due to, in spite of, on behalf of, in addition to, according to.

Prepositional phrases can act as adjectives or adverbs depending on what they modify.

MCQ key at a glance

Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key
1	b	2	c	3	a	4	b	5	b
6	b	7	c	8	c	9	b	10	c

How to attempt this unit in the paper

- For device questions, name the device, quote a short example and explain its effect.
- For paraphrase, preserve the scene and emotion without forcing rhyme into the prose answer.
- For summary, include encounter, key imagery and later emotional impact—without personal evaluation.
- For connotation, explain why one near-synonym sounds gentler, harsher or more poetic than another.
- For prepositional phrases, identify the object of the preposition and the word the phrase modifies.